



YOUNG PEOPLE CAME OUT ON THE STREETS TO PROTEST QUOTAS FOR OBCS

Youngistan, or some equally revolting newer name that I'm too not-with-it to know, means I'm obsolete. Which is a huge relief.

We're a young nation, and we're completely obsessed with youth, and with making the young feel responsible and overburdened. Our life sucked, we tell them, now make things better. In the West, everybody is grateful if young people manage to stay off drugs, out of jail and are able to identify up to four countries on a world map. Which is fine. Young people are supposed to be confused, clueless, emotionally unstable and generally annoying. We've all been there. Some of us never left. In India, not only are young people expected to make a genuine impact—

which is silly, because by the time you're in a position to change things in any field you're not young any more, no matter how early you start—but they're supposed to do it in some sort of uniform direction, as if they're all part of some great big team. Everybody's favourite homogenous target group. Which is absurd, to say the least. There is no Representative Youth; there's just people. Indians are diverse. You knew that, right? Not just in ethnicity, language, religion, education, socio-economic background, but also in purpose. Tomorrow's religious fundamentalists, moral guardians, corrupt politicians, rapacious businessmen, sexual predators and mass murderers are all young now. They're

their total income.

March 2008 India wins U-19 cricket World Cup while the older team is skittled in theirs.

2009 Indian youngsters

become wired, increasingly owning more and more gadgets, from mobiles to home computers, ipods, digital cameras and more, according to a TCS survey in 2009.

2009 Parliament gets the largest collection of young MPs with 82 between the ages of 25 and 40. And they range from professionals to dynasts, political wives to actors.



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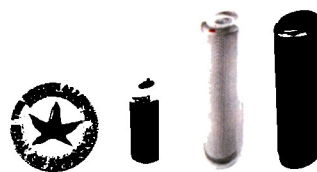
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